

THE ORDER OF THE ELEMENTS IN THE VERBAL STATEMENT CLAUSE IN 1 Q SEREQ ⁽¹⁾

1. — In many languages, *exempli gratia* in English, the order of the elements in a syntactic structure is of considerable importance. This is true in the verbal clause in Hebrew, a fact noticed by most grammars (2). This paper seeks to describe this facet of Hebrew syntax as it occurs in the dialect represented by the *Rule of the Community* (= 1 Q S). The material provided by this single text is severely limited, but the limitation can be defended on the ground that it is desirable that a study of this sort be, in so far as is possible, synchronic (3).

2. — The "Verbal Clause" in Hebrew is defined for the purposes of this study as a verbal element together with any other

(1) The material presented in this paper is drawn from the author's Ph. D. thesis, *A Structural Analysis of the Grammar of 1 Q S*. The paper therefore owes a great deal to the advice and criticism of Prof. J. W. WEVERS, who directed that thesis. He also had the kindness to criticize the paper itself. Quotations from 1 Q S are transliterated in the standard manner, save that § is used to represent $\var�$ with no phonological implications.

(2) Few, however, go into adequate detail.

(3) 1 Q S may be a compilation, as claimed by M. MARTIN, in *The Scribal Character of the Dead Sea Scrolls*, Louvain, 1958, p. 44, 55, 365, 371. MARTIN's information, however, is not exhaustive. The grammar of the various sections differs negligibly, if at all. 1 Q S may therefore be subjected to a "synchronic" analysis, insofar as the term is applicable to a written text in a dead language. Many scholars would no doubt include the *Rule of the Congregation* (= 1 Q Sa) in this analysis, as it is generally thought to have originally formed a part of the same scroll as 1 Q S. However the grammar of that scroll does differ from that of 1 Q S both in morphology and in syntax: e. g., the 3 m. pl. suffix -hm is used in 1 Q S twice, -hm 6 times. In 1 Q S -hm appears once (VIII, 21), -hm 31 times. (See MARTIN, *ibidem*, vol. I, p. 54* list 35 c, to which add IV, 23; V, 3, 6. for 36.) In 1 Q Sa 'nšy occurs once, and 'nšv five (or six, cf. II, 8) times. In 1 Q S only 'nšy appears (29 times). In 1 Q Sa about 28% of the verbal statement clauses begin with the verbal element; in 1 Q S about 50% begin in this way. A detailed comparison of syntax is difficult because of the many lacunae in 1 Q Sa. Finally 1 Q S and 1 Q Sa differ slightly in size, and in the number of lines per column. I find it difficult to believe that they formed part of the same scroll.

elements which show concord with it or modify it. *Id est* a verbal clause is a structure the headword of which is a verb. A "Statement Clause" is here defined as any verbal clause which does not contain either interrogative or relative pronouns, or imperative verb forms (4).

3. — *The Verbal Element (V).*

The simplest form of the verbal element is a single verb form (v). Any verb form consists of a verbal base augmented by a bound pronominal element (5). These pronominal elements form two paradigms. In one the bound pronouns are all suffixed to the verbal base. In the other the pronominal elements appear either as prefixes, or as a combination of prefix and suffix. In this way verb forms in *I Q S* can be morphologically defined. The verb forms marked out by this definition differ from other words in their syntax as well as in morphology (6).

4. — The verbal element in a verbal clause appears in two ways other than as a single verb form. The verbal element may be made up of two verb forms joined by a conjunction (c). In this case any other elements forming part of the same verbal clause show concord with, or modify, both verb forms (7).

5. — When a verb form is negated, the negative immediately precedes the verb form. It does not, therefore, change the position of any element in the clause in relation to the verb or to other

(4) Interrogative and relative pronouns always stand first in a clause and are thus predetermined as to order. (Note that the relative pronoun can stand only as the subject or object of a clause. Elsewhere, it does not form part of the clause it precedes.) *I Q S* contains only five imperative verb forms, three of which occur in quotations from the Old Testament. The remaining two are obviously inadequate for a study of the imperative clause in *I Q S*.

(5) In the verb form traditionally called the "3rd. masc. sing. perfect" no pronominal element is visible. However, just as the singular noun in English is not marked except by its contrast to the plural (n: :n + s) so the "3 m. s. perfect" verb form in Hebrew is marked by the fact that it lacks the markers necessary to place it in any other position in the verbal paradigm. Hence the 3 m. s. pronoun is in this case represented by the act of choosing the 3 m. s. perfect verb form from among the other available forms. (See W. HAAS, *Zero in Linguistic Description*, in *Studies in Linguistic Analysis* (Special Volume of the Philological Society) Oxford, 1957, p. 43). In simplification of this fact, the 3 m. s. pronoun can be said to be represented by a "zero morpheme". (See Z. S. HARRIS, *Componential Analysis of a Hebrew Paradigm*, in *Language* 24, 1948).

(6) This statement may seem unnecessary, but is included to justify the exclusion of other forms (e. g. participles and infinitives, sometimes loosely called verbs) from the class verb.

(7) E. g.: W'NW W'MRW II, 5; YQRB 'W YRHQ VI, 16.

elements. It may therefore be considered, for the purpose of this study, to be a part of the verbal element (8).

6. — The symbol V is used to indicate the verbal element. As described above, the exponent of V in the verbal statement clause in *I Q S* may be a single verb form (V is v), two verb forms joined by a conjunction (V is v cv), or a verb form preceded by a negative (V is neg. v). A verbal element appears in every verbal clause, and may constitute a verbal clause by itself (9). Only one verbal element appears in any one clause (10).

7. — *The Noun* (n).

The noun is the most common class of word in *I Q S*. It may therefore be expected to play a major part in the verbal statement clause. The nouns in *I Q S* can be isolated morphologically by the fact that they are capable of augmentation by some or all of a paradigm of suffixes (11). The base to which these augments are bound may itself occur without inflectional augment as a noun. In such cases it can be recognized as a noun by the syntactic positions which it occupies.

8. — Nouns are very often modified by other words or word groups. The noun is then the "headword" of the structure formed by itself and its modifiers. Any structure of which the headword is a noun has syntactic functions identical with those of the noun. *Id est* it can substitute for a noun in any structure in which a noun can occur, without changing the grammatical meaning of that structure. Hence it is called a "noun substitute" (12).

(8) The same is true of a negative modifying any other element.

(9) *E. g.*: YDBR VI, 13; LW' YTHRW V, 13.

(10) That is, only one verbal element appears as a "clause-building element" in any one verbal clause. Verbs may occur as parts of other elements, *e. g.* in a relative clause forming part of a nominal element.

(11) *E. g.*: -YM, -H, -WT, etc.

(12) The main types of noun substitute found in *I Q S* are:

a) The bound noun structure, consisting of a noun preceded by one or more nouns in bound (or "construct") form. *E. g.*: 'NŠY HYHD IX, 10; 'YBT 'WLM IV, 17.

b) Two (or more) nouns joined by a conjunction. *E. g.*: following a bound noun: RWYH 'MT W'WL IV, 23; following a preposition: LRWRW WM'SW VI, 17; in concord with a verb: WHWSYPW HKWHNYM WHLWYYM II, 11.

c) A noun followed by an attributive modifier. *E. g.*: ŠNH TMYMH VI, 17; H'YŠ HNS'L VI, 11.

d) A noun modified by another noun. *E. g.*: HNGHL 'T B 'T VIII, 15; LMWŠB HRBYM 'YŠ BTKWNW VI, 8; possibly 'NŠY HTMYM QWDŠ VIII, 20.

e) A noun modified by a noun preceded by a preposition (see below). *E. g.*: HKTWB LPNYW VI, 10-11; HPQYD BRW'S HRBYM VI, 14.

f) A noun modified by an infinitive preceded by a preposition (see below). *E. g.*: HMTNDBYM LŠWB... V, 22; probably HGWRL LQRBW LYHD VI, 22. Besides the simple forms, various combinations of these structures can occur as noun substitutes.

9. — A noun substitute of another type is the pronoun. Pronouns form a class of limited membership the members of which do not conform to the morphological characteristics of the noun. They cannot take the paradigm of inflectional affixes by which noun forms are augmented. They do, however, themselves form a paradigm comparable to that formed by the nominal affixes. They also occupy the syntactic positions permissible to nouns. They are therefore to be regarded as noun substitutes, or, perhaps more conveniently, as a subclass of the noun (13).

10. — The symbol N indicates a noun or noun substitute. As indicated above, any noun or pronoun, any structure the head-word of which is a noun or pronoun, or any other structure the syntactic function of which is the same as that of a noun or pronoun, is considered to be an exponent of N in a verbal statement clause.

11. — *The Nominal Elements* (N^s, N, pN) (14).

Exponents of N function in *I Q S* in four ways. One of these has already been mentioned. Verb forms contain an exponent of N in the form of a bound pronoun. These bound pronouns are allomorphs of the personal pronouns. These allomorphs occur only in this position, and the position can be occupied by no other type of exponent of N. The position of these bound pronouns in relation to the verbal base has no effect on, or relation to, the position of the other elements in the verbal statement clause. Consequently their position can be ignored in the present study.

12. — *The N^s element.*

In some cases exponents of N are said to show concord with verb forms. In fact they show concord with the bound pronoun in the verb form. Where this is the case, the noun or noun substitute is distinguished by the symbol N^s. Only one exponent of N^s can occur in any one verbal statement clause.

(13) Other rarer types of noun substitutes found in *I Q S* are:

a) Clauses; when preceded by the relative pronoun 'sr, and in the form of quotations modifying verbs formed on bases such as 'mr, ktb, yd'. *E. g.*: l'sr bhr 'l XI, 7 is a pN element (see below). Clauses modify 'mrw II, 11; 'd'h X, 16.

b) Infinitives; when following the bound form of a noun, *e. g.*: kwl ywmy mw'sw III, 5, and when co-ordinated with N, *e. g.*: mkwl tw'bw' šqr wht-gwll.... IV, 21.

c) A nominal structure preceded by a preposition. *E. g.*: kwl hwlyk bh IV, 6. 12; wl'wsh byd rmh lw' yswb IX, 1.

(14) For the meaning of these symbols see par. 12-14.

13. — *The N element.*

Where a noun or noun substitute modifies the verb, concord is not a relevant factor. Such nouns or noun substitutes are indicated by the symbol N. More than one exponent of N can occur in any verbal statement clause.

14. — *The pN element.*

The fourth way in which nouns and noun substitutes function in the verbal statement clause in I Q S is in the pN element. Here they are preceded by a preposition (p), and modify the verb. Prepositions form a class of limited membership the members of which are recognizable only from their syntactic function. They stand before exponents of N and infinitives, and cannot be separated from them.

15. — Among the exponents of p are two morphemes, both written 't. These two morphemes are formally distinguished only when they occur bound to a bound pronoun. In this case one appears as 'wt- (15), and the other as 't- (16). These two morphemes are not otherwise grammatically distinguished in I Q S. Consequently, although there is some doubt as to whether 't/'wt- is a true preposition (17), all instances of 't, 't-, and 'wt- in I Q S must be treated as exponents of p (18).

16. — The pN element is, therefore, composed of an exponent of p followed by an exponent of N. More than one exponent of pN can occur in any one clause.

17. — *The Infinitive (i).*

Infinitives form a class of unlimited membership, but appear in only a small number of forms. These forms show morphological connection with the verbal bases. The infinitive functions in two ways in the verbal statement clause in I Q S. Most commonly, it occurs in the pI element described below. In a few other cases it functions as a noun substitute. In these latter cases it is, of course, indicated by the symbol N (19).

(15) In I Q S only 'wtm V, 18.

(16) In I Q S m'tm VI, 3; VII, 16; 'tw VI, 12; 'ty VI, 13.

(17) *Id est* a sufficiently large text might show a difference between the syntactic function of 't/'wt- and the other prepositions.

(18) 't/'wt- occurs as p in a pN element in a verbal statement clause in VI, 7. 19. 19. 25. 25. It modifies a participle or infinitive more often than it does a verb. These occurrences are quoted by T. LEAHY, *Studies in the Syntax of I Q S*, in *Biblica*, vol. 41, 1960, n° 2, p. 152-154, with the omission of I, 4; VI, 12 and VI, 25 (the last word). The inability to distinguish 't/'wt- from 't/'t- recalls AQUILLA's translation of the former by συν. Even DAVID QIMHI treated the two preposition as two uses of one word: see Miklöt ed. RIT-TENBERG, *Lyk*, 1862, p. 188 b.

(19) See note 13.

18. — *The Infinitival Element (pI).*

Where the infinitive does not function as a noun substitute, it occurs in the pI element. In this structure, the infinitive is preceded by a preposition, and modifies the verb. The infinitive itself is usually modified by exponents of N, and/or pN, and/or pI (20). The pI element, then, consists of a preposition followed by an infinitive, or by any structure the headword of which is an infinitive. More than one exponent of pI can occur in any one clause.

19. — *The Particles (pt).*

Under this title are listed the words 'z, 'hr, b'trm, trm, kkh, kn, 'wd, šm, and tmyd. These words all occur in verbal clauses in *I Q S*, but they do not occur in sufficient numbers to permit their division into smaller classes (21). Particles rarely occur between the elements already described. They are not, therefore, of great interest to the discussion of the positions permissible to the major clause-building elements in relation to each other, but only for their position in relation to the beginning of the clause.

20. — Other particles do, of course, occur in verbal clauses. They, however, either form part of a clause-building element (22), or mark the relation of the clause to other clauses in the text (23). The former have been described as far as is necessary, and the latter, since they do not affect the order of the elements in the clause, are of no concern to this study (24).

21. — The verbal statement clause in *I Q S* is, then, made up from the elements V, N^s, N, pN, pI, and pt. As was suggested above, the order in which these elements occur in the verbal clause is of considerable syntactic importance. V is the only element which is indispensable to the verbal clause. It therefore seems most logical to study the order of the elements in relation to V.

(20) These modifiers may precede the combination p+i, but usually follow it. If the infinitive is negated, the negative stands immediately before the combination p+i, or, where p is L-, and the negative BLTY, between p and i.

(21) That a division according to position and function could be made is suggested by the fact that some particles precede the verb and some follow it. Some appear only in verbal clauses; some can be used elsewhere, and so on.

(22) E. g. negatives, and "emphatics" such as 'k and rō.

(23) E. g. conjunctions, and particles such as kv' and 'm which mark the clause they precede as included in a larger complex.

(24) Those particles which indicate the relation of clauses to each other are not considered to form part of the clauses.

22. — *The Positions occupied by N^s.*

- a) N^s follows V in less 67 clauses. Thus:-
 V N^s 47 clauses.
 V N N^s 6 clauses. (Only where N is a pronoun
 bound to the verb) (25).
 V pN N^s 11 clauses.
 V pt N^s 2 clauses.
 V N^s pN cN^s 1 clause (26).
 b) N^s precedes V in less 34 clauses. Thus:-
 N^s V 29 clauses.
 N^s pN V 3 clauses.
 N^s pN cpN V 1 clause.

In one clause, the place of N^s is taken by an exponent of pN acting as a noun substitute. The exponent of N in this pN element shows concord with the verb (27).

23. — *The Positions occupied by N.*

- a) N follows V in 132 clauses which contain a single exponent of N. In 10 clauses containing more than one exponent of N, all exponents of N follow V. Thus:-

V N	113 clauses
V N N	6 clauses
V N N ^s N	1 clause
V N ^s N	2 clauses
V N ^s N cN	1 clause
V N ^s N N N	1 clause
V N pN N	1 clause
V pN N	12 clauses
V pN pN N	1 clause
V pN pN pN N	1 clause
V N ^s pN N	2 clauses
V pN N ^s N	1 clause

- b) N precedes V in 22 clauses which contain a single exponent of N. In 2 clauses containing more than one exponent of N, all exponents of N precede V. In none of these cases does any other element stand between N and V.

(25) For a full description of the positions occupied by N^s and N in clauses containing exponents of both, see par. 27-28.

(26) WYHY 'STW LYHD WMŠPTW VI, 22-23. This is the only case in I Q S in which two exponents of N joined by a conjunction are separated by any other element.

(27) WL'WŠH BYD RMH LW' YŠWB 'WD IX, 1. For pN as a noun substitute, see note 13. For the same structure in the massoretic text, see *Deuteronomy* 24, 5; *Isaiah* 32, 1; *Jeremiah* 9, 2.

c) In 4 clauses exponents of N both precede and follow V. In none of these cases does any other element stand between N and V.

24. — *The Positions occupied by pN.*

a) pN usually follows V. This occurs in 128 clauses containing a single exponent of pN. In 52 clauses containing more than one exponent of pN, all of them follow V.

b) pN precedes V in 52 clauses containing a single exponent of pN. In 3 clauses containing more than one exponent of pN, all precede V.

c) In 18 clauses exponents of pN both precede and follow V.

d) If exponents of N^s or N follow V, they stand between V and a following pN, except in the few cases to the contrary listed above. In three cases, exponents of pI stand between V and a following pN (28).

e) Where pN precedes V, no other element stands between pN and V. Hence in four clauses, one or more exponents of pN stands between V and a preceding N^s (see par. 22).

25. — *The positions occupied by pI.*

a) pI usually follows V. This occurs in 38 clauses containing a single exponent of pI. In 14 clauses containing more than one exponent of pI, they all follow V.

b) pI precedes V in 10 clauses containing a single exponent of pI.

c) In 5 clauses, exponents of pI both precede and follow V.

d) If a clause contains exponents of N^s, N, or pN, they stand between V and pI, except in the three cases noted above, where pI stands between V and a following pN.

26. — *The positions occupied by particles.*

a) The particles occur in a variety of positions, as follows: 'z, 'HR, BTRM, TRM, KKH, and KN occur in verbal clauses only as the first element. In 13 clauses one of these particles stands immediately before the verb. In one clause an exponent of pI separates 'HR from the verb.

b) šM always follows the verb. It occurs in two clauses immediately after the verb. In both it is followed by an exponent of N^s (29).

(28) The most certain case is QLL 'w LHE'T MŠRH 'w LKWL DBR... VII, 1; V cpI cpN. The other two clauses compose the passage IX, 26 šPTYM to X, 8 DRWR. Although obscure in detail, the structure of this passage is sufficiently clear to show that in both clauses, pI elements stand between the verb and pN elements.

(29) See VI, 3. 6.

c) 'wd always follows the verb. It occurs immediately after V in 5 clauses. In one of these it is followed by pN, and in one by pI (30). In one clause 'wd is separated from V by pN (31).

d) TMYD occurs only once in a verbal statement clause. Here it follows V but is separated from it by N^s (32).

27. — *Clauses containing exponents of both N^s and N.*

The position occupied by exponents of N^s and N when both occur in the same clause is of considerable interest. If the exponents of N^s and N are, for instance, both masculine singular form nouns, although the former shows concord with the third person masculine singular pronoun in the verb form, confusion is possible, unless N^s and N are distinguished by the positions they can occupy in the clause. The evidence suggests that they were so distinguished in this text.

28. — The positions in which N^s and N occur when both are contained in a verbal clause are as follows:

N ^s V N	11 clauses.	I, 11-12; III, 17. 17-18.25; IV, 25; VI, 5.5-6.8-9; IX 1-2; XI, 10. 17-18.
N ^s V N N	1 clause.	IV, 16-17
N ^s V pN N	3 clauses.	II, 18. 24-25; X, 18
N ^s V pN pN N	1 clause.	II, 21
N ^s V pN pN pN N	1 clause.	II, 19-20
N ^s pN V N	1 clause.	VII, 16
N ^s pN cpN V N	1 clause.	IV, 18
V N ^s N	2 clauses.	I, 18-19; VI, 11
V N ^s N cN	1 clause.	IX, 3-6 (cf. lines 5-6)
V N ^s N N N	1 clause.	XI, 5-7
V N ^s pN N	2 clauses.	IV, 20; VI, 1
V pN N ^s N	1 clause.	VIII, 20
V N N ^s	4 clauses.	II, 8.16; V, 14-15; VI, 14
V N N ^s N	1 clause.	II, 5-6
N V N N ^s	1 clause.	IV, 25
N V N ^s	3 clauses.	III, 26-IV, 1; X, 23; XI, 17 (33)

29. — These positions can be summarized thus:

N^s usually precedes V. In this case N follows V. 19 clauses.

(30) See VII, 2 and VIII, 26.

(31) VII, 24. Cf. VII, 2.

(32) X, 23.

(33) The exponent of N in the last-named clause is preceded by the negative *by*.

Where both N^s and N follow V , N usually follows N^s . 7 clauses. If, however, the exponent of N is a pronoun, it may be bound to V and thus precede N^s . 6 clauses.

In four clauses N precedes V . In this case N^s follows V (34). It is interesting to note that, of the four cases in which N precedes V , in three it is syntactically impossible to mistake N for N^s , and in the fourth the mistake is lexically impossible. Nevertheless where N precedes V confusion could no doubt occur (35).

30. — The other fact of particular interest elicited by this study concerns the pI element. The very clear positional distinction between pN and pI shows that the setting up of the infinitive as a word class distinct from the noun is correct. In connection with the pI element it should also be noted that there is a distinction between the types of pI element which appear before and after V . The exponents of p occurring in pI elements preceding the verb are $B-$ (14 times) and $K-$ (once). Those occurring in pI elements following the verb are $L-$ (68 times), $B-$ (9 times), $'D$ (6 times), $'L$ (once), and $'M$ (once). Evidently the exponents of p capable of standing in a pI element preceding the verb are strictly limited. It might be correct on this basis to recognize two sub-classes of p : p' the members of which could stand only in the colligation $V pI$, and p'' , the members of which could stand both in the colligation $V pI$ and in the colligation $pI V$.

31. — Finally it is advisable to record the order of the elements in a verbal statement clause in relation to the beginning of that clause, since this is the method most often used in studies of this sort. This study is based on 338 clauses. The distribution of the first element is as follows (36):

V	181 clauses				
N^s	34 clauses	thus:-	$N^s V$	30 clauses	
			$N^s pN V$	3 clauses	
			$N^s pN cpN V$	1 clause	
N	27 clauses	thus:-	$N V$	25 clauses	
			$N N V$	1 clause	
			$N cN cN V$	1 clause	

(34) One of these examples has already been counted as containing the order $V N N^s$.

(35) It is possible that in the spoken language the unusual position of N preceding V would be indicated by the pitch contour of the clause, or by some similar marker.

(36) "First element" means here, of course, the first of the six clause-building elements discussed in this study.

pN	68 clauses	thus:-	pN V	65 clauses
			pN pN V	1 clause
			pN cpN V	2 clauses
pI	14 clauses	thus:-	pI V	13 clauses
			pI pN V	1 clause
pt	14 clauses	thus:-	pt V	13 clauses
			pt pI V	1 clause

This information is interesting for comparison with other dialects, but does not appear to be of the same importance for the syntax of the clause as is the information derived from the order of the elements in relation to V.

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